Juan Manuel Gelay

Product Design Manager · Conversational AI & B2B SaaS

Buenos Aires, Argentina (UTC-3) · juanmanuelgelay@gmail.com · juanmagelay.github.io · linkedin.com/in/juanmagelay · github.com/juanmagelay

Summary

Product Design Manager with 10 years in fintech, banking and messaging products, combining design strategy, people leadership and hands-on craft. At Auronix I lead a team of Product Designers and Conversational UX Designers that has launched 25+ WhatsApp bots and AI agents for enterprise brands like Banorte, General Motors and Chedraui, and designs the self-service platform where those brands build templates, campaigns and flows. My team's AI collections journey for Banorte does the work of about 28 agents.

I've built three design systems and two design teams. I stay hands-on: I design conversational flows, prototype with AI and contribute code to the team's internal tools, with an AI-first workflow from discovery to production. Background in business administration.

Experience

Auronix

Conversational AI and messaging platform (WhatsApp Business API) for enterprise brands in Mexico

Product Design Manager · Feb 2025 - Present

- Lead and coach a team of 6 designers (3 Product Designers, 3 Conversational UX Designers) embedded in the Finance, Retail, and Cross Industry & Telco tribes and in the Platform team, and partner cross-functionally with Product Owners, engineering leads and the VP of Product through weekly one-on-ones (1:1s) and team rituals.
- Launched 25+ WhatsApp bots and AI agents with the team since 2023 across financial services (Banorte, Banco Azteca, Spin by OXXO), retail (Chedraui, Elektra, Farmacias Similares, Innovasport, Spin Premia), telco (izzi, Totalplay) and automotive (General Motors).
- **Banorte, credit card collections:** led the team that designed a conversational AI journey on WhatsApp, combining an AI agent with WhatsApp Flows. It resolves **79%** of 125K monthly conversations without human agents, the workload of about **28 collection agents**, and turns 10% of those conversations into payment commitments, 2 points above the human agents' target.
- **Banco Azteca, satisfaction surveys across customer touchpoints:** my team replaced a 21-message conversational survey with a single WhatsApp Flow form. Completion time dropped from 25.2 to 14.1 seconds (**1.8x faster**), completion rate rose from 77% to **86%**, and the bank saves an estimated **MXN 3.3M** a year.
- Defined the team's career strategy: a framework with two parallel tracks (Conversational UX and Product Design), 8 roles and 34 skills, AI skills embedded at every level, and semiannual, evidence-based promotion reviews tied to objectives and key results (OKRs).
- Wired the Auronix Design System into an AI-first workflow from wireframe to production code, plus WhatsApp Mockups Studio, an internal prototyping tool I also code on.
- Guided hypothesis-driven discovery to redesign outbound campaign analytics in the client platform:

user interviews with platform clients, integration clients and Customer Success Managers (CSMs), a 6-platform competitive benchmark, and a real-time plus analytics architecture defined with engineering.
- Co-lead a go-to-market enablement program with the VP of Product: product showcases and a Claude-based system where Product Owners and designers turn new use cases into standard sales decks.

Product Design Lead · Mar 2023 - Feb 2025

- Built the design team I lead today.
- Designed the Auronix Portal from scratch, hands-on: the single self-service platform that replaced the 4+ separate channels clients had to use, where brands build and send WhatsApp templates, track message metrics, manage their bots and build flows. Later handed ownership to a Product Designer on my team.
- Built the Auronix Design System from scratch as the main stack for the company's core product: styleguide, component and UI libraries in Figma used by front-end developers across the company.

Wenance

Fintech

UX Manager · Jan 2022 - Mar 2023

- Built the design system from scratch for 5 countries and 8+ brands.
- Hired and mentored designers and researchers.

IntermediaIT

UX & Product Lead · Apr 2021 - Jan 2022

- Built the UX team from scratch for Kuspit and other client projects.

Senior UX/UI Designer · Jan 2020 - Apr 2021

- Won the Kuspit project, a Mexican fintech, and designed its iOS and Android apps, web app and website.
- Designed products for other clients of different sizes and industries.

Banco Supervielle

Senior Product Designer · Jan 2017 - Jan 2020

- Led the redesign of the B2B online banking platform.
- Created, with my team, the bank's design system and design process, shared with every product area.

Teaching

Coderhouse

UX Professor · Jan 2020 - Oct 2025

- Taught 10 UX and product design courses on weekends, 700+ students in total, and created course content. Net Promoter Score (NPS) of 98 in my classes.

Skills

- **Leadership and strategy:** design strategy, roadmap prioritization, people management and coaching,

hiring, career frameworks, performance and promotion reviews, design operations (DesignOps), cross-functional work with product, engineering and sales.

- **Product and UX:** user research and discovery, usability testing, conversational design, WhatsApp Business API (templates, interactive messages, WhatsApp Flows), design systems, B2B SaaS, key performance indicator (KPI) and dashboard definition.
- **AI-first design:** Claude Projects as reusable team assets (sales decks, career framework), Claude Design wireframes turned into high-fidelity Figma screens with real design system components through the Figma Model Context Protocol (MCP) server, Claude Code for prototypes and front-end contributions, and prompt design for large language model (LLM) agents. Also Figma Make, v0 and Cursor.
- **Tools:** Figma, FigJam, Maze, Optimal Workshop, Google Analytics, Notion, Jira, GitLab, HTML, CSS, JavaScript.

Education

- **University Technician in Video Game Programming** · Universidad Nacional de Hurlingham · `2020 - Present` (95% complete, expected Jul 2027). Intermediate degree of the Bachelor's in Video Game and Simulation Development, which I continue in 2027.
- **Postgraduate Program in User Experience Design (UX)** · Instituto Tecnológico de Buenos Aires (ITBA) · `2020`
- **UX Design Program** · EducaciónIT · `2017 - 2019`
- **Bachelor's in Business Administration** · Universidad Nacional de La Matanza · `2008 - 2016`

Certifications

- **Interaction Design Foundation:** 9 courses and 1 master class, with distinction in 8 courses (top 10% of class, best in class in two)
  - `2026` Game UX Design: The Ultimate Guide · Object-Oriented UI Design: Build Interfaces Users Love (best in class) · Visual Design: The Ultimate Guide
  - `2025` Perception and Memory in HCI and UX (best in class)
  - `2024` Agile Methods for UX Design · AI for Designers · UI Design Patterns for Successful Software · Design Systems: How to Craft Successful Components (master class)
  - `2023` UX Management: Strategy and Tactics · Gamification: How to Create Engaging User Experiences
- **Coderhouse:** JavaScript and React · `2021`

Languages

Spanish (native) · English (B2+, Duolingo Score 129) · Portuguese (B2, Duolingo Score 115)